

HESTIA

GODDESS OF THE HEARTH

Hestia was responsible for the hearth—the place where a fire is lit in the home. It was her job to keep a fire alight on Mount Olympus at all times. Both Poseidon and Apollo wanted to marry her, but she turned them down, and she chose not to have children.

PARENTS: Cronos and Rhea

CHILDREN: None

SACRED SYMBOLS



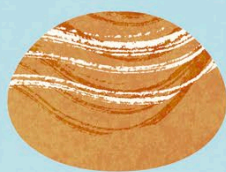
VEIL

Hestia was usually seen wearing a veil over her hair.



FIRE

Fire and the lit fireplace represented Hestia's blessing over the household.



BREAD

Bread was baked in the hearth, and so was associated with Hestia.



KETTLE

Hestia sometimes held a kettle as a symbol of her management of the house.



HEARTH AND HOME

Hestia was incredibly important to the people of Greece. She was always given the first sacrifice made in the home, regardless of which other gods were being honored. Because the Greeks saw cities as extensions of the home, she also took care of them.